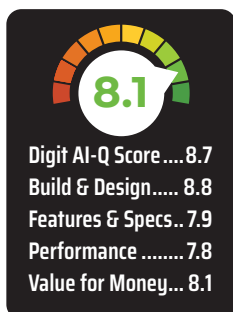


Samsung Galaxy S25

Same old, but OneUI 7 is special

It's been around 15 days since Samsung launched its most anticipated smartphone series. I've been using the vanilla Samsung Galaxy S25 during this time, and I've observed several important aspects that could help you make an informed purchase decision. While Galaxy AI appears to be a game-changer with features designed to solve everyday problems, my experience reveals a different story. Despite having what Samsung calls their most AI-capable smartphone, I found myself using only one or two AI features regularly over the past two weeks. This raises important questions: Are these AI features truly necessary? Is the Samsung Galaxy S25 worth its Rs 80,999 price tag? What are its significant drawbacks? And how does it compare to its primary competitor, the iPhone 16? In this comprehensive review, I'll address these questions and more to help you make the right choice.



BUILD AND DESIGN

The Samsung Galaxy S25's form factor makes a striking first impression out of the box. While Samsung has maintained its signature design language over the years, this iteration brings welcome refinements. The S25 stands out with its slim profile, lightweight build, and compact dimensions that offer excellent ergonomics for both pocket carry and handling.

The device's build quality matches its comfort. Protected by Corning Gorilla Glass Victus 2 on both front and back panels, along with Armor Aluminum frames, the S25 exhibits premium durability. The IP68 rating provides reliable protection against water and dust exposure. However, the sleek dimensions can occasionally make the device feel less

robust than its actual build quality suggests.

Despite these positive attributes, the S25's visual design shows minimal evolution from its predecessor, the Galaxy S24. The new Icy Blue colourway, while sophisticated, lacks excitement. That said, the Navy Blue variant offers a more

compelling aesthetic with its refined, professional appearance.

PERFORMANCE

The Galaxy S25's premium experience extends beyond its design to its sophisticated software implementation with One UI 7. Having used both the iPhone 16 and Galaxy S25 as primary devices, I can confidently say One UI 7 stands as a worthy competitor to Apple's iOS, which is often considered the industry standard.

One UI 7 distinguishes itself through fluid animations, extensive customization options, and exceptional app optimization. The integration of AI features, coupled with Samsung's commitment to 7 years of OS updates, surpasses Apple's current software support timeline.

Samsung's continued partnership with Google has elevated the intelligence of the S25 through Gemini AI integration with Bixby. The enhanced Settings app now understands natural language queries – type "My eyes are burning," and it immediately suggests Eye Comfort Shield settings. This intuitive problem-solving approach sets the S25 apart from its competitors.

Among the AI features, Audio Eraser proves particularly useful for content creators. It offers separate controls for Voices and Noise with adjustable intensity scales. However, it's not without limitations – setting Voices to the maximum while minimizing Noise doesn't completely eliminate background sounds, and the inverse setting fully mutes voices.

Overall, One UI 7 delivers a refined, fluid, and engaging experience. While the AI features show practical utility and promise, some aspects still require fine-tuning to reach their full potential.

Regarding performance, the Galaxy S25's Snapdragon 8 Elite chipset delivered mixed results in benchmark testing. In Antutu, it scored approximately 2 million points – a somewhat disappointing figure considering devices like the Vivo X Fold 3 Pro and iQOO 12 achieved similar scores with older hardware.

However, the device showed more promising results in Geekbench, with both single-core and multi-core scores outperforming other flagship smartphones. Thermal performance testing revealed some limitations. Using an enhanced stress test with 40 threads over 30 minutes (double the standard parameters), the S25 exhibited significant throttling and noticeable heat generation. While maximum performance metrics were satisfactory, the average performance scores fell below expectations.

In daily use, the S25's performance is largely excellent, with thermal management being the primary area for improvement. Heat buildup becomes apparent during demanding tasks like gaming sessions and extensive camera use. Despite these thermal challenges, the device offers a smooth experience across most usage scenarios.